exposure to a mega city like New York. Jal aluddin and Samsuddin were self-reliant, positive, optimistic men who undertook their work with the assurance of success. It is from these two persons that I drew the core creative power of my mind. My sentiments could not be contained, and I could feel the mist of tears in my eyes. Then, Jal aluddin said, “Azad, we have always loved you, and we believe in you. We shal always be proud of you”. The intensity and purity of their faith in my capabilities broke my last defences, and tears wel ed up in my eyes.

* * *

II

CREATION

[1963 – 1980]

4

Achievers

I started my work at NASA at the Langley Research Centre (LRC) in Hampton, Virginia. This is primarily an R&D centre for advanced aerospace technology. One of my most vivid memories of LRC is of a piece of sculpture depicting a charioteer